

Concise-Curiosity

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Introduction

Welcome to 'Concise-Curiosity', the seventh module in the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we'll cover how to write copy that hooks your readers and keeps them reading until the very end.

DISCLAIMER: I highly recommend watching every previous module before watching this module, as we'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be harder and more complicated.

Link to the FULL video version: [Concise-Curiosity Video](#)

Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

join copy skool: <https://www.skool.com/copyskool>

The Enemies of Great Copy

There are two principles that, if you don't understand, can put a massive dent in the effectiveness of your copy.

The human brain is wired to prefer efficiency & stimulation.

- > *We don't like wasting energy.*
- > *We don't like to be bored.*

We must keep this in mind when writing copy. It would be a shame for you to nail their specific conditions, craft a perfect problem chain, and create urgency and scarcity...

All for someone to click off because your copy is too complicated or boring.

We aren't writing English papers here. We're writing words that grab attention and hold it.

The C.U.B. Method

Robert Bly (a well-respected author and copywriter) developed a simple method to ensure our copy abides by those principles — [The C.U.B. Method](#).

You must assume that your readers/viewers are looking for ANY and EVERY reason to stop consuming your copy and carry on with their life.

For this reason, we should use the C.U.B. method to ensure readers make it through our sales message in the fastest, easiest, & most enjoyable way possible.

Robert states that there are 3 main reasons why a reader wouldn't make it through your sales message:

- > **Confusing Copy**
- > **Unbelievable Copy**
- > **Boring Copy**

Before we dig into the details, let's overview how to use this method effectively:

1. Write an 'emotional' rough draft(s).
 - a. *DO NOT worry about fixing any spelling mistakes or perfecting what you're writing, just spew our words.*
 - b. *Only focus on channeling the raw emotion you're trying to convey.*
 - c. *Focus on volume, put down a million ideas, don't worry about how good they are.*
2. Take a break.
 - a. *Get your mind completely off copy.*
 - b. *Go outside, go do something active.*
 - c. *Don't come back until you are fresh mentally.*
3. Come back and look for/mark/fix any copy that is 'confusing.'
 - a. *It should be so simple that a monkey could understand it.*
 - b. *Simplifying is hard, but you should 'absorb' the pain of action so that your customers don't have to.*
 - c. *Use the notes from the 'Fixing Confusing Copy' section below.*
4. Take another break.
 - a. *Get your mind completely off copy.*
 - b. *Go outside, go do something active.*
 - c. *Don't come back until you are fresh mentally.*
5. Come back and look for/mark/fix any copy that is 'unbelievable.'
 - a. *The outcomes/claims/proof you use should be exciting, BUT believable and realistic.*
 - b. *Use the notes from the 'Fixing Unbelievable Copy' section below.*
6. Take another break.
 - a. *Get your mind completely off copy.*
 - b. *Go outside, go do something active.*
 - c. *Don't come back until you are fresh mentally.*

7. Come back and look for/mark/fix any copy that is 'boring.'
- Every word matters. Every word should 'earn its keep'. (no fluff)*
 - You should be able to 'glide down' the page like a slippery slope.*
 - Simplify, remove & condense.*
 - There's no such thing as copy too long, just copy too boring.*
 - Use the notes from the 'Fixing Boring Copy' section below.*

Fixing Confusing Copy

- > Remove esoteric points.
 - Don't go too in-depth about details/stuff your audience doesn't care about.*
 - SPECIFIC CONDITIONS!!!!*
 - Avoid 'techno-babble'.*
 - People care more about the results than the 'how'.*
- > Avoid confusing language.
 - Simplify everything*
 - 3rd-5th grade reading level.*
 - Layman's speak.*
- > Vague explanations.
 - Use specific, concrete & visual language.*
 - Language that appeals to the 5 senses. They should have a 'movie' playing in their head.*
 - If you can't visualize what you're saying, fix it.*
- > Distracting ideas/rabbit holes.
 - ONE BIG, SIMPLE, USEFUL IDEA*
 - Don't stray from the main idea, it isn't worth the distraction it causes.*

Fixing Unbelievable Copy

(100% DEPENDENT ON SPECIFIC CONDITIONS!!)

- > Cut the section/claim out completely.
- > Make the claim more believable.
- > Add very specific and compelling proof.
- > Relate to the reader/viewer using specific conditions.

Fixing Boring Copy

- > Don't talk too much about what they already know.
 - a. *Match their current awareness level!!!*
 - b. *Specific Conditions & Problem Chains.*
- > Not enough emotions being pushed.
 - a. *Text-Subtext.*
 - b. *Pain-Confidence.*
 - c. *Concrete, visual language.*
- > Using way too many/complicated words.
 - a. *Simplify everything*
 - b. *3rd-5th grade reading level.*
- > Mountain Copy, NOT Brick Copy.
 - a. *Varying sentence length.*
 - b. *Use connector words/phrases.*
 - c. *Make it visually easy & fun to read.*
- > Vague explanations.
 - d. *Use specific, concrete, visual language.*
 - e. *Language that appeals to the 5 senses. They should have a 'movie' playing in their head.*
 - f. *If you can't visualize what you're saying, fix it.*

Let's go over some good & bad examples of each concept so you get a better understanding of what to look for:

> [Concise Examples](#)

The C.U.B. method is all about removing reasons why someone WOULDN'T read your copy.
(Removing the negatives.)

Creating curiosity is giving a reason why someone WOULD read your copy.
(Adding in positives.)

Now that your copy is concise, let's add in the flavor of curiosity.

Curiosity

Curiosity is one of the most powerful motivators for holding attention and creating action.

- > *It's the reason you click on thumbnails.*
- > *It's the reason you watch murder mysteries.*
- > *It's the reason you keep reading great copy.*

We create curiosity by introducing a **'knowledge gap'** — *a mental 'itch' your reader has to scratch.*

It's called the **'knowledge gap'** because you're proposing a gap between the information they currently know and the information they need to know to get their desired result/outcome/resolution.

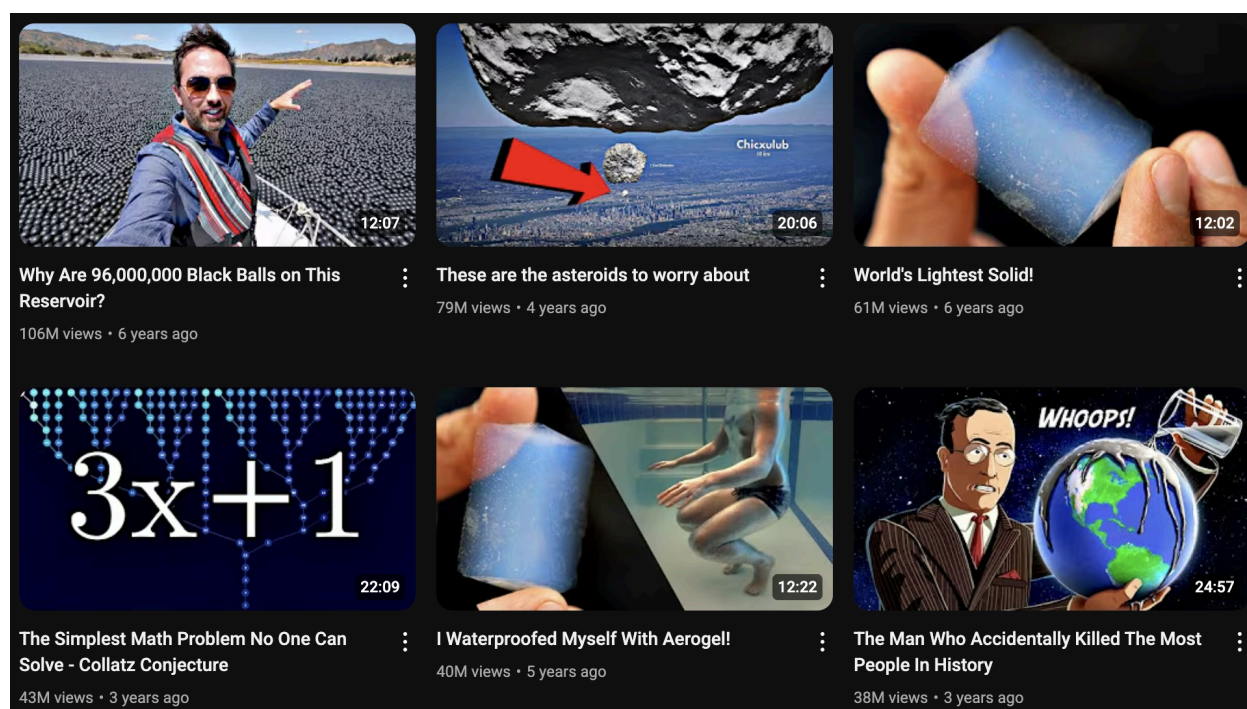
Curiosity happens when your audience knows just enough to feel like they're missing something important.

Your job as the marketer is to **grab their attention by creating the gap**, and then **hold their attention by not closing it too soon.**

> *For entertainment, you can create curiosity using anything intriguing, whether it's useful or not.*

> *For selling, you create curiosity using their desired outcome as leverage.*

Entertainment Example:



The **mental itch** that Veritasium creates with his thumbnails is so strong that tens of millions of people are willing to trade an action (*clicking the thumbnail*) for scratching that itch. (*filling the knowledge gap, getting their mental Q's answered*)

By **slowly releasing more information** throughout the video, he holds the attention of his viewers, and then finally answers the question at the end, filling the knowledge gap. Satisfying the itch.

Selling Example: [Iman Ghadzi's 'ONE Thing' Promo](#) (DOC VERSION [HERE](#))

Let's go over how we can use these concepts in our marketing.

Creating The Gap

We create a 'knowledge gap' by directly or indirectly posing a question/problem that your audience wants to know the answer to.

In copywriting, we typically do this by showing them how they're missing 'something' (*some secret/hidden information*) they need to achieve their desired outcome.



Kinda like there's a 'question-mark lock' separating them from where they are now (*current nightmare situation*) and where they want to be. (*future dream situation*)

They can unlock this 'lock' by taking the action that we want them to take.

This can be done directly or indirectly.

> More Indirect: *When we looked at the data, we noticed something weird that completely changed our marketing forever. Let me explain.*

> More Direct: *There's ONE secret technique that could quite possibly DOUBLE the returns from your marketing efforts.*

As always, which route you should take depends on your audience's specific conditions. Use your critical thinking skills. Which approach do you think would work the best for this specific campaign?

Let's go over some tactical ways you can leverage curiosity in your marketing:

1. A Glipse of a Solution

- a. Give them a glimpse of something they don't know — but need to.
- b. EX: *Most people are one sentence away from doubling their prices.*
- c. EX: *There's a reason your emails aren't getting opened. It's not what you think.*

2. Ask a Provocative Question

- a. Make them question what they thought they knew.
- b. EX: *"What if everything you knew about productivity was wrong?"*
- c. EX: *"Why are 7-figure coaches using this ugly landing page?"*

3. Contradiction / Paradox

- a. Flip expectations — say something that sounds wrong but is actually right.
- b. EX: *"We stopped posting content... and grew faster."*
- c. EX: *"How our worst-performing ad made the most money."*

4. Open a Story Loop (Cliffhanger)

- a. Start a story or insight — but don't finish it.
- b. EX: *"I was 2 days away from quitting... and then this happened."*
- c. EX: *"We tested 5 headlines. One crushed the rest — but it shouldn't have."*

5. Imply a Hidden Secret

- a. Suggest there's something exclusive or untold beneath the surface.
- b. EX: *"Nobody talks about this part of freelancing... but it matters more than your skill."*
- c. EX: *"We discovered something weird buried in the data..."*

6. Shock or Surprise (Pattern Interrupt)

- a. Break expectations to re-hook attention.
- b. EX: *"This is what happens when you drink 7 coffees before a sales call."*
- c. EX: *"We deleted 30% of our list... and made more money."*

7. Tease the Result — But Not the How

- a. Show off the outcome... hold back the process.
- b. EX: *"He went from \$0 to \$10k/month in 43 days."*
- c. EX: *"This one strategy added 1,203 subscribers overnight."*

8. Use Odd or Specific Details

- a. Random or hyper-specific facts pull the brain in.
- b. EX: *"How a Ukrainian bakery helped us fix our onboarding process."*
- c. EX: *"The \$7 PDF that made us \$100,000."*

9. Turn the Mirror on the Reader

- a. Make them question themselves (and seek clarity).
- b. EX: *"Are you unknowingly pushing leads away?"*
- c. EX: *"If you had to sell 10x more tomorrow, would you know what to change?"*

10. Call Out Mistakes or Hidden Problems

- a. Trigger fear of doing something wrong or missing out.
- b. EX: *"If you're writing emails like this, you're leaving thousands on the table."*
- c. EX: *"Most businesses sabotage their sales calls in the first 10 seconds."*

11. Use Incomplete Comparisons

- a. Make an analogy — but don't explain it fully.
- b. EX: *"This sales funnel works like Netflix, but better."*
- c. EX: *"Think of it like a gym — but for closing clients."*

12. Taboo or "Forbidden" Framing

- a. Imply something edgy or off-limits.
- b. EX: *"The persuasion trick banned from TV ads."*
- c. EX: *"This was so aggressive, Facebook almost banned our account."*

13. Use Numbers — Without Context

- a. Quantify the outcome, but leave the "why" unanswered.
- b. EX: *"7 reasons we stopped running retargeting ads."*
- c. EX: *"\$22,000 in one day — and it wasn't even a launch."*

14. Visual Curiosity Triggers (for Videos/Thumbnails)

- a. Use imagery that raises questions.
- b. EX: *Blurred-out faces*
- c. EX: *Out-of-context screenshots*
- d. EX: *Weird expressions*
- e. EX: *Censored text*
- f. EX: *Split-screen contrast*

15. Time Bomb Framing (Urgency Curiosity)

- a. Imply that something big is actively unfolding or on the clock.
- b. EX: *"We only have 4 days to make this work."*
- c. EX: *"We're losing \$1,000/day until we fix this."*

16. Curiosity Power Words & Phrases

- a. EX: *"Weird trick"*
- b. EX: *"Nobody talks about this"*
- c. EX: *"What happened next shocked us"*
- d. EX: *"Insider secret"*
- e. EX: *"Unexpected lesson"*
- f. EX: *"Stupidly simple"*
- g. EX: *"Almost gave up..."*
- h. EX: *"This blew my mind"*
- i. EX: *"The internet lied to you..."*

Holding Attention

Once you've grabbed someone's attention, you need to hold onto it while delivering your sales message/moving them through your funnel.

Everything you've learned in this entire course will affect how well you hold your audience's attention, but I want to briefly cover how this ties into the concepts from this module.

The two main variables in holding attention:

1. How compelling your hook/knowledge gap is.
 - a. How intriguing is the question you raised in their mind? How deep did you dig the 'hook'?
 - b. Once the gap is created, how much would someone be willing to pay to 'scratch the mental itch'?
 - c. YouTube Educational Ex: 'Would someone pay \$100 for this video if it delivered on the promise?'
2. The pace at which you release information.
 - a. To hold someone's attention, you have to 'drip-feed' them information, making them feel like they're getting closer to the big answer/pay off.
 - b. Give away too much, too fast, they'll feel like they got the answer already and move on.
 - c. Give away too little, too slow, they'll get bored/unmotivated and move on.
 - d. Balance being unexpected. Too much chaos and they'll get confused, but a great plot twist/pattern interrupt is a great way to re-engage people.

The **key to holding attention** is by creating a powerful curiosity gap that they HAVE to solve, then giving them just the right amount of information at the correct speed to keep them engaged.

Simple example of creating and holding attention: Murder Mysteries

- > It starts by opening a juicy loop that you want solved.
- > As it progresses, you are given intriguing clues that lead you to make some assumptions about the culprit, but not enough to be 100% sure it's them.
- > You are also hit with unexpected turns along the way that make you rethink the assumptions you've made.
- > It ends with an epic pay-off as the murderer is exposed and your mental 'itch' is scratched.

Your copy should feel similar.

The BIGGEST curiosity mistake I see beginners make:

- > Giving away too much information, too fast.

People love mystery. Don't give everything away immediately because you don't wanna be 'salesy'.

String them along just enough to keep them intrigued and excited.

IMPORTANT: How much to change each variable completely depends on the specific conditions of your audience and the consumption patterns of the medium of your copy.

EX: *An 18-year-old watching an Instagram reel is gonna need to be exposed to more info at a faster pace VS a 50-year-old reading a sales letter they received in the mail.*

Always use your critical thinking skills based on the principles you've been taught throughout this course.

To tie everything together, let's take a look at how I've leveraged concise-curiosity in one of my successful sales pages:

> [KJ Sales Page Example](#)

Concise-Curiosity Checklist

Since this module is very tactic-heavy, it can feel a bit overwhelming at first. To combat this, here is a simple checklist you can use to increase the effectiveness of your copy.

1. Have you simplified your copy as much as possible?
 - a. *Simple language?*
 - b. *Simple examples?*
 - c. *Stuck to the ONE big idea?*
 - d. *As few words as possible?*
2. Is your copy as entertaining as possible?
 - a. *Appeals to their emotions/desires?*
 - b. *Does it use visual, concrete language?*
 - c. *Is it easy to read/formatted well?*
 - d. *Avoided techno-babble?*
3. Are your claims believable?
 - a. *Is your proof solid?*
 - b. *Do your claims match your audience's current belief of what's possible?*
4. Have you created a compelling 'knowledge gap' to hook your audience?
 - a. *What question are you trying to imply?*
 - b. *Is it JUICY to your audience?*
 - c. *Does it feel like they HAVE to know the answer?*
5. Are you releasing 'clues' to the question at the right pace?
 - a. *Does the rate of release fit the medium your copy is on?*
 - i. *IE: faster for shortform, slower for longform*
 - b. *Does the rate of release fit the audience you're targeting?.*
 - i. *IE: faster for youngsters, slower for uncles*

6. Do you have any tasteful 'plot-twists' or pattern interrupts to increase engagement?
- a. Do you remind them of the hook throughout to keep them hooked?
 - b. Use this sparingly.

When doing your Hyper-Learning Cycle, feel free to use these questions to break down other people's copy to study how they used these concepts. 👍

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #🌟course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ - KJ

Link to the FULL video version: [Concise-Curiosity Video](#)

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